



Page 1 of 7 · Two Dark Paths

The woodland picnic ends beneath a purple sky. Ted-E-Bear sets out 8 little lanterns for the paths, with 6 spare lanterns waiting in his wagon. One path leads to Honey-Beats’s cottage and the other leads to his own. “Nobody should walk home in the dark,” Ted says.



Page 2 of 7 · The Windy Bend

At the bend, the wind blows out 2 of Honey-Beats’s 4 lanterns. Ted hears a worried little hum beyond the trees and turns back.



Page 3 of 7 · A Brave Small Glow

Two lanterns are not much, but Honey-Beats holds them high. “Small lights still count,” she says. Ted moves the 2 still-glowing path lanterns to the narrow bridge, one on each side.



Page 4 of 7 · Fireflies Join In

Three fireflies settle near each lantern. Their gold-green light makes the bridge sparkle, and Honey-Beats’s shoulders finally relax.



Page 5 of 7 · The Last Hill

The cottage window appears at the top of the hill. Ted still has the 6 spare lanterns in his wagon and wants both friends to carry the same number.



Page 6 of 7 · Light in Every Window

Honey-Beats places 3 lanterns outside. Ted places 3 inside. The cottage glows like a tiny sunrise, and the dark no longer feels so large.



Page 7 of 7 · A Promise Kept

Before Ted leaves, Honey-Beats gives him half of 4 honey biscuits for his walk. “You came back for me,” she says. Ted smiles. “That is what friends do.” They relight the path lanterns for the walk home.

Questions for Ted-E-Bear and the Lantern That Needed a Half

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · Two Dark Paths

If Ted shares 8 lanterns equally between 2 paths, how many lanterns light each path?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4 · 6

Page 2 · The Windy Bend

Honey-Beats had 4 glowing lanterns and 2 went out. How many are still glowing?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Page 3 · A Brave Small Glow

Ted doubles 1 lantern so both sides match. How many lanterns are there altogether?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Page 4 · Fireflies Join In

There are 2 lanterns with 3 fireflies beside each one. How many fireflies are helping?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6 · 8

Page 5 · The Last Hill

What is half of 6 lanterns?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4 · 6

Page 6 · Light in Every Window

What is double 3?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6 · 8

Page 7 · A Promise Kept

How many biscuits is half of 4?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 4. A half means two equal groups. Share one lantern to each path until all 8 are used: 4 on each path.

Page 2: 2. Take away the 2 lanterns that went out: 4 - 2 = 2.

Page 3: 2. Double 1 means 1 + 1. That makes 2.

Page 4: 6. There are two equal groups of 3. Count 3 + 3 = 6 fireflies.

Page 5: 3. Split 6 into two equal groups: 3 and 3. Half of 6 is 3.

Page 6: 6. Double 3 is two groups of 3: 3 + 3 = 6.

Page 7: 2. Four shared into two equal parts is 2 and 2. Half of 4 is 2.

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